

Curriculum

Courses in major subject or related fields (20-30 ECTS)

Compulsory courses

- A course on research ethics
- Subject specific compulsory courses

Courses that support your PhD project

- **Advanced-level courses** in the major subject or related fields
- **Methodological courses:** e.g., statistics, experimental design, bioinformatics tools

Conferences (Max 5 ECTS)

- 5 ECTS requires active participation with one's own contribution in at least two international conferences

General skills/minor subject area (0-10 ECTS)

- University pedagogics courses
- Language courses (max 5 ECTS)

Studying at other universities

- Studies may also be completed at other universities.
- Through the **Doctoral+** (Tohtori+) network, doctoral courses at other Finnish universities are free of charge; add the course to your study plan in Peppi. A separate agreement also covers University of Turku courses outside the network. See [Doctoral studies at ÅAU](#).

Licentiate degree

- A licentiate degree (30 ECTS of studies and a licentiate thesis) can also be completed; a doctoral degree taken after it only requires the doctoral dissertation. See the [programme page](#).
-

Useful resources

-  [Skills and Competencies \(DOCX\)](#)

Last updated: 26 September 2026